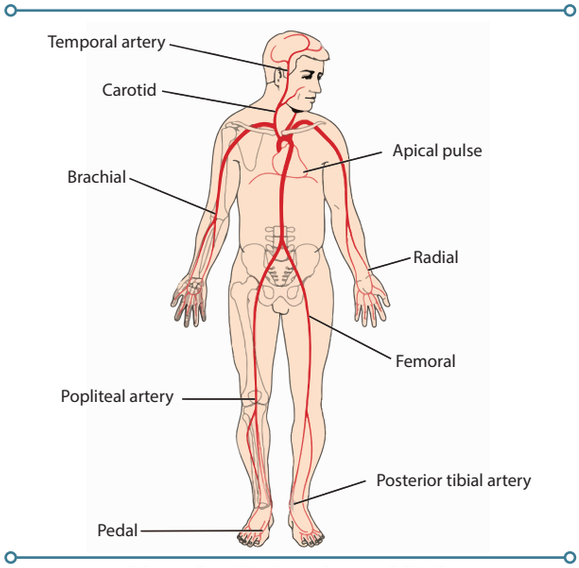
nerve decrease heart rate and sympathetic stimulation of the SA node increases the heart and force of contraction.

ASSESSMENT OF PULSE

Any artery can be assessed for pulse rate, but the radial and carotid arteries are easily palpated.

SITES FOR PALPATION OF PULSE

Site	Location
Temporal	Over temporal bone of head. Above and lateral to eye.
Carotid	Along medical edge of sterno-cleido mastoid muscle in neck.
Apical	Fourth and fifth intercostal space at left mid clavicle line.
Radial	Radial or thumb side of forearm at wrist.
Ulnar	Ulnar side of fore arm at wrist.



Sites for Palpation of Pulse

Character of the pulse

Assessment of radical pulse includes measurement of the rate, rhythm, strength and equality.

Rate

Pulse rate is counted for minute when the patient is in a sitting, standing and lying position.

Rhythm

Normally a regular interval occurs between each pulse and heartbeat.

Strength

The strength or amplitude of a pulse reflects the volume of blood ejected against the arterial wall with each arterial contraction.

Factors influencing pulse rate

- **Fitness level:** Sort term exercise increases pulse rate. An athlete, who participates in long – term exercise will have lower pulse rate at rest.
- **Temperature:** Fever and heat increase pulse rate Hypothermia decreases pulse rate.
- **Emotion:** Pain and anxiety increase pulse rate.
- **Medication:** Epinephrine increase pulse rate. Digoxin decrease pulse rate.
- **Hemorrhage:** Blood loss increases pulse rate.
- **Body position:** In standing or sitting positions, pulse rate increases. In lying down position, the pulse rate decreases.
- **Pulmonary condition:** Caused poor oxygenation and decreases in pulse rate.

Purpose of Recording pulse

- To test the health and efficiency of heart.
- To test the elasticity and the health of arteries.

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